

Licensed AI-Ready Data Marketplace

Lean Business Plan & 6-Month Roadmap

October 16, 2025

Abstract

We propose a marketplace where creators can list and license datasets (and model-ready corpora) to AI builders. The platform differentiates on three pillars: (i) a standardized *Data Nutrition Label* with an objective *Quality Score*, (ii) provenance and rights verification (incl. C2PA support for media), and (iii) license clarity for compliant global use (EU/UK/US/CA). This document outlines positioning, the MVP scope, technical and compliance architecture, payments, incorporation options (Ireland vs. Canada), a six-month roadmap, indicative costs, and first-year KPIs.

1 Positioning & Value Proposition

Problem. AI teams waste time discovering, vetting, and lawfully licensing training data. Existing data shops under-serve indie creators and rarely surface AI-relevant quality and provenance.

Solution. “Airbnb for datasets” with trust baked in:

- **For sellers:** easy listing, license presets, automated quality checks, provenance badge, fast payouts.
- **For buyers:** searchable catalog, comparable Data Cards (coverage, bias, leakage checks, PII risk), clear license scope, audit-friendly receipts.

2 Offering & Revenue

What We List First

Indie creator datasets: text corpora, tabular collections, labeled images/audio, and synthetic datasets with disclosed generation recipes.

Licensing Menu (presets)

Non-exclusive commercial (default), evaluation-only, no-redistribution, derivatives allowed/forbidden, time-boxed exclusivity option, region scoping (EU/UK/US/CA), and “train-only” options.

Monetization

- Marketplace take rate: **10–20%** per transaction (processing fees pass-through).
- Premium “**Data Plus**” badge: continuous validation, refresh, and red-teaming.
- Private brokerage for enterprise deals (higher margin).

3 MVP Scope (8–12 weeks)

Seller Studio

Upload → auto-scan (schema, dedupe, PII/toxicity, basic stats) → choose license preset → price → generate Data Card & Quality Score → list.

Buyer Flow

Faceted search (domain, license, score, risk), preview samples, checkout, instant license document + signed download URL, dispute/escrow window.

Trust & Governance

Rights attestation workflow, notice-and-takedown (DMCA/DSA), immutable audit logs, C2PA¹ support on eligible listings.

4 Quality Score (0–100)

Weighted rubric surfaced on every listing:

- 1) **Provenance & Consent (25%)**: traceability, creator identity, opt-in confirmations, content credentials.
- 2) **Legal Clarity (20%)**: license scope, third-party rights, territory, revocation terms.
- 3) **Statistical Health (20%)**: coverage, balance, duplicates, missingness, leakage/drift checks.
- 4) **Annotation Quality (15%)**: guidelines, spot audits, inter-rater agreement.
- 5) **Technical Integrity (10%)**: formats, schema versioning, checksums.
- 6) **Harm & PII Risk (10%)**: red flags and mitigations.

Additionally, we compute light-weight benchmark probes to emit “*Best for*” tags (e.g., RAG finance QA, ASR fine-tune, long-tail classification).

5 Technology & Hosting

Stack (EU-anchored, privacy-first)

- **Frontend**: Next.js (TypeScript), Tailwind, SSR for SEO.
- **Backend**: FastAPI (Python) or NestJS (Node). Background jobs via Celery/Redis or BullMQ.
- **Database**: Postgres (managed: RDS/Cloud SQL).
- **Search**: OpenSearch/Elasticsearch for catalog and vector facets.
- **Object Storage (EU)**: AWS S3 (eu-west-1), GCP Cloud Storage (europe-west1), or Cloudflare R2 (zero egress to Cloudflare CDN).
- **CDN**: Cloudflare.
- **Security/Observability**: SSO/OAuth (Google/Microsoft/GitHub), role-based ACLs; Sentry + structured logs.
- **Provenance**: C2PA claims for media; cryptographic hashing; immutable audit trails.
- **Email/Billing Docs**: Postmark (receipts), DocuSign (enterprise license addenda).

¹Coalition for Content Provenance and Authenticity claims for supported media.

6 Payments: Stripe vs. Revolut

	Stripe (Connect)	Revolut Business
Marketplace payouts	Mature split payouts, KYB/KYC, tax tooling	Basic payouts; fewer marketplace primitives
Indicative EU card fees	~1.5% + €0.25 (EEA consumer)*	~1% + €0.20 (EEA consumer)*
Payout fee	~0.25% of payout volume (Connect tiering)	Varies by plan/bank rails
Dev DX / APIs	Excellent; webhooks at scale	Good; simpler stack in EU

Recommendation: Start on **Stripe Connect** for marketplace plumbing; add Revolut as an alternate EU rail later.

**Rates are indicative and may vary by card type, country, and plan. Verify before launch.*

7 Compliance & Law (sell fairly across EU/UK/US/CA)

IP/Database Rights

US: facts are not copyrightable, but compilations (selection/arrangement) can be; EU/UK: *sui generis* database right may apply. Licenses must clearly cover database rights, copyrights in annotations, and third-party media/model releases.

Text & Data Mining (TDM)

EU: commercial TDM permitted unless rightsholders opt out (machine-readable). The pipeline should detect/record opt-outs; list only compliant sources or explicit opt-ins. UK: TDM exception is largely non-commercial; secure licenses for commercial TDM.

Marketplace Liability

Implement DMCA (US) notice-and-takedown; DSA (EU) notice-and-action; repeat-infringer policy; designated agent in the US.

Privacy

If personal data is present: GDPR/UK GDPR/PIPEDA alignment; DPA with buyers (processor/processor or controller/controller, as appropriate); SCCs/IDTA for cross-border transfers; DSAR workflow. Consider avoiding personal data in public listings; offer anonymization/pseudonymization services.

US State Patchwork & Data Brokers

Support access/delete/opt-out requests (CCPA/CPRA and similar). If deemed a “data broker” in some states (e.g., CA, VT), register or exclude such datasets.

EU AI Act Readiness

From 2025–2027, foundation/GPAI providers face dataset transparency and governance duties. Our Data Card, provenance, license receipts, and audit logs make buyer compliance easier.

License Templates

Start with familiar open-data and ML-focused templates (e.g., ODC/ODbL/PDDL and MDL-style terms) adapted to presets: train-only, eval-only, no redistribution, derivative rights, territorial scope.

8 Incorporation: Ireland vs. Canada

	Ireland (Private LTD)	Canada (Federal Corporation)
Gov. filing (online)	€50 (Form A1) [†]	CAD \$200 (federal)
Extras	EEA-resident director or Section 137 bond (€1,800/yr)	NUANS name search (\$13.80) + provincial registrations
Pros	EU base (GDPR/AI Act proximity); EU cloud regions	Simple federal regime; NA market proximity
Cons	Director/bond requirement; EU admin	Extra-provincial admin if operating widely

[†]Fees are indicative as of 2025; verify with the CRO/Corporations Canada before filing.

9 Website & Infrastructure Providers (initial picks)

- Domain + DNS: Cloudflare.
- Hosting: AWS (eu-west-1) or GCP (europe-west1); minimal lift with managed Postgres + object storage.
- Storage: start S3 or Cloudflare R2; enable server-side encryption and lifecycle policies.
- CI/CD: GitHub Actions; IaC via Terraform.
- Monitoring: Sentry, Cloud provider logs.

10 6-Month Roadmap

Month 1: Company setup; payment rails; draft Seller/Buyer agreements, TOS, Privacy, DPA; provision cloud; skeleton upload → scan pipeline.

Month 2: MVP vertical slice: upload, license presets, quality scan, Data Card, listing, checkout, payouts.

Month 3: Seller dashboards; buyer orgs; download tokens; escrow/dispute.

Month 4: Trust features: C2PA badge, DMCA/DSA portals, TDM opt-out detection; “Best for” tags.

Month 5: Curated *Data Plus* channel; private deals; SOC2-lite hygiene; add SEPA/ACH.

Month 6: Scale supply (100–300 creators), weekly showcase; measure repeat buyer rate; plan partner listings (cloud marketplaces).

11 Budget (illustrative, monthly)

Line Item	Estimate	Notes
Cloud storage (2 TB active)	€30–€50	R2/S3/Cloud Storage, EU region
Managed Postgres	€60–€150	Starter tier
Search (OpenSearch)	€80–€200	Small cluster
CDN/Transfer	€0–€50	Cloudflare free/pro
Monitoring/logging/email	€50–€150	Sentry, Postmark, provider logs
Payment processing	pass-through	~1–2.8% + fixed; Connect payout ~0.25%
Company admin	€100–€300	Registered office, bookkeeping (avg.)

12 Year-1 KPIs

- Supply: >1,000 datasets; $\geq 70\%$ carry “Data Plus” badge.
- Demand: >200 paying buyers; $\geq 25\%$ 90-day repeat rate.
- Trust: <1% takedown rate; median provenance grade A; disputes resolved <5 days.
- Economics: 30–40% blended gross margin after fees.

13 Immediate Next Actions

1. Decide jurisdiction (IE if EU-first; CA if NA-first) and file.
2. Implement upload $\rightarrow$ scan $\rightarrow$ license $\rightarrow$ list $\rightarrow$ pay flow.
3. Seed 20–30 indie creators; run QA for free to build inventory.
4. Launch search + checkout + license PDFs; publish policy pages (DMCA/DSA, TDM stance).
5. Start weekly “Quality-only” newsletter; court 3–5 pilot buyers.

Appendix A: Dataset Card (JSON skeleton)

```
{
  "name": "IE English Accents ASR v1",
  "version": "1.0.2",
  "creator": {"name": "Aoife Byrne", "contact": "aoife@example.com"},
  "provenance": {"collection_method": "opt-in recordings", "c2pa": true
  },
  "license": {"type": "non-exclusive", "commercial_use": true, "
    redistribution": false},
  "statistics": {"hours": 120, "speakers": 340, "snr_db_mean": 21.3},
  "quality_score": {
    "overall": 87,
    "dimensions": {"provenance": 95, "legal": 90, "stats": 84, "
      annotation": 80, "technical": 88, "risk": 85}
  },
  "risks": {"pii": "low", "notes": "names redacted"},
  "best_use": ["ASR pretraining (EN-IE)", "Accent robustness"],
  "audits": [{"date": "2025-10-10", "checks": ["dedupe", "pii", "snr"], "
    issues": []}]
}
```

Disclaimer. Fees and regulatory notes are indicative (as of 2025) and not legal advice; verify rates and obligations before launch.